PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION

Ministry of Agriculture, Livestock, Land and Irrigation

LIMITED COMPETITIVE EXAMINATION FOR RECRUITMENT TO GRADE III OF SRI LANKA AGRICULTURAL SERVICE - 2024 (2026)

APPLICATIONS are invited from public Officers who have completed the following qualifications for the limited Competitive Examination for the recruitment of Officers to 125 vacant posts as at 30.06.2024 in Grade III of the Sri Lanka Agricultural Service mentioned in following Section 1, under the provisions set out in the Sri Lanka Agricultural Service Minute. These qualifications should be completed by the last date of calling applications.

In this notification, the **"Minute on the Sri Lanka Agricultural Service"** includes the Sri Lanka Agricultural Service Minute" published in the *Extraordinary Gazette* No. 1880/26 and dated 19.09.2014 of the Democratic Socialist Republic of Sri Lanka and all amendments made to it so far and to be made in the future. "Appointing Authority" shall mean "Public Service Commission", "Secretary" shall mean the "Secretary of the Ministry-in-Charge of the subject of Agriculture", "Service" shall mean "Sri Lanka Agricultural Service" and "Appointment" shall mean "an appointment to the Grade III of the Sri Lanka Agricultural Service" and "Written Examination" shall mean "Limited Competitive Examination for Recruitment to Grade III of the Sri Lanka Agricultural Service Grade 2024(2026)" and the term "Officer" unless otherwise specified shall mean "an Officer of the Sri Lanka Agricultural Service." The closing date for application is **16th of October, 2026**. The examination will be conducted by the Commissioner General of Examination in **January 2027** in Colombo only.

Stream	Post	No. of Vacancies	Code of the post
Agricultural Development	Assistant Director of Agriculture, (Agricultural Development)	75	1
Agricultural Research	Assistant Director of Agriculture Agricultural Research	44	2
Agricultural Economics	Assistant Director of Agriculture (Agricultural Economics)	06	3

1. Posts Vacant/ Number of Vacancies

- The application is published under 'Our Service' - Online Applications - Recruitment/ E.B Exams' in the web site - **www.doenets.lk** of the Department of Examinations Sri Lanka and applications can be submitted online only. The acceptance of online applications will open at **09.00 a.m. on September 21st 2026** and **close at 09.00 p.m. on October 16th 2026.**
- Officers must submit a copy of the application to their Heads of Institutions for inclusion in their personal files. At the time of being called for the interview, a certified copy of the application and a letter confirming service, certified by the Head of the Institution, must be presented.
- Applicants must bear any adverse consequences resulting from delaying their application submission until the deadline.

Note :-

In the limited competitive examination, one applicant can apply for only one of the above stream posts.

02. Method of Recruitment :-

2.1 Written Examination :-

The written examination consist of the following two question papers and the syllabus is given in the first appendix of this notification :

Subjects	Time (hours)	Maximum Marks	Pass Marks
Intelligence Test Paper	1 1/4	100	40
Subject Matter Paper (In accordance with the relevant post)	2	100	40

2.2 In order to pass the written examination. 40% or more marks are required for each question paper.

2.3 Structured Interview : Basic qualifications of candidates who pass the written examination will be scrutinized and marks will be awarded to seniority. Candidates who score 40% or more marks in each subject of the examination will be called for interview.

2.3.1. Method of awarding Marks for Seniority at the Interview. The period of active service of an applicant with effect from the date

fulfillment of prescribed qualification up to the closing date of applications shall only be reckoned for the purpose of awarding marks for seniority. Subject to a maximum of 30 marks, at a rate of 02 marks for each year of such period of active service and at a rate of 01 mark for a period of service extending to 180 days or more shall be awarded.

2.4 Subsequent to submitting the marks obtained by the candidates in the interview for seniority to the Sri Lanka Department of Examinations, the Department of Examinations will prepare final merit list of limited competitive examination for each post by adding marks for seniority and marks of written examination and forwarded it to the Public Service Commission. The Public Service Commission will make recruitment to the relevant posts based on the merit order of the priority list.

2.5 Upon obtaining the concurrence of the Secretary to the Public Service Commission, the Commissioner-General of Examinations shall notify the results to all candidates who sat for the examination individually or publish the same on the *website* of the Department of Examinations at **www.results.exams.gov.lk.**

03. Terms and Conditions of Engagement :-

3.1 This post is permanent and pensionable. Further, you should contribute to Widows'/ Widowers' and Orphans' pension fund and make contributions as stipulated by the government from time to time.

3.2 Appointees must agree to serve in any part of the island.

3.3 All Officers in the Sri Lanka Agricultural Service are subject to serve in all Provincial Public Services as required. For this purpose the Officer will be temporarily released to a post in the Provincial Public Service. Such term of service will be determined on the consent between the relevant Provincial Authority and the Appointing Authority according to exigencies of service, requirement of the cadre and other connected matters.

(a) Provincial authority will issue a letter of appointment to the relevant Officer subject to the conditions of release from the service. The Officers appointed to Provincial Councils will be subject to the transfers within the Provincial Council made by the relevant Provincial Authority.

(b) An Officer shall be subject to the administration and disciplinary control of the Public Service Commission, even during his period of service in the Provincial Public Service.

(c) An Officer who released to the provincial public service shall return to his/her substantial post at the end of the period he/she so released.

3.4 Officers appointed to Grade III on the results of Limited Competitive Examination will be subject to a one year acting period. Officers appointing through Limited recruitment shall pass the First Efficiency Bar Examination within three (03) years.

3.5 **Skills Development** :- Skills Development will be provided to the Officers recruited to the service through one (01) month training programme to acquire the skills on trends of Socio Economic and Cultural in relation to agricultural development and job environment by the Department of Agriculture or any other institute (*Example :* Sri Lanka Institute of Development Administration) identified by the Department At the end of the programme, a certificate will be awarded after an assessment. This certificate should be obtained for the confirmation in the service.

3.6 Selected candidates will be placed in Grade III of the Sri Lanka Agricultural Service subject to the General terms and conditions governing appointments in the Public Service, provisions of the Service Minute of Agricultural Service of Sri Lanka, Regulations of the Department, provision of the Establishment code and financial Regulations of the Democratic Socialist Republic of Sri Lanka, the Rules of Procedure of the Public Service Commission (hereinafter referred to as Procedural Rules) published in the *Gazette Extra Ordinary* No. 2310/29 of 14.12.2022 and any amendments hereinafter thereto to the above Terms, Conditions, orders, Provisions, Regulations and Rules.

3.7 Recruited Officers are required to obtain the competency in the second language within prescribed period as per provisions of Public Administration Circular No. 18/2020 and the Circulars incidental thereto.

04. Monthly Salary Scale :

The consolidated monthly salary scale assigned to these posts as per Public Administration Circular 10/2025 is as follows:

SL-01-2025-Rs.82,150-2400x10-2,940x8-3,900x17-Rs. 195,970/-

Recruitment will be made to Grade III of the Sri Lanka Agricultural Service.

Salaries will be paid to the appointees in accordance with Schedule III of Public Administration Circular 10/2025.

05. Qualifications

5.1 Basic Qualifications :

5.1.1 For Streams of Agricultural Development

(a) An Officer who holds a post of Agricultural Instructor in Special Grade of the Sri Lanka Technological Service

Or

(b) An Officer who holds a post of Agricultural Instructor and has completed at least 10 years active and satisfactory period of service in the Sri Lanka Technological Service or Provincial Technological Service.

(c) An Officer of the Associate Officer Service category who has obtained a four year Bachelor' degree in Agriculture from a University recognized by the University Grants Commission and has completed five (05) years active and satisfactory period of service under the Department of Agriculture or Provincial Departments of Agriculture and has directly involve or be involving in the duties of the Department of Agriculture or the Provincial Departments of Agriculture.

Or

(d) An Officer who holds a post of Garden Assistant and has completed 10 years active and satisfactory period of service

Or

(e) An Officer who holds a post of Agricultural Instructor or Garden Assistant possessing a degree in Agricultural Science or Science and has completed 05 years active and satisfactory period of service.

5.1.2 For Stream of Agricultural Economics

(a) An Officer who holds a post of Economist Assistant and has completed 05 years active and satisfactory period of service

Or

(b) An Officer of the Associate Officer Service category who has obtained a four year Bachelor's degree in Agriculture from a University recognized by the University Grants Commission and has completed five (05) years active and satisfactory period of service under the Department of Agriculture or Provincial Departments of Agriculture and has directly involved or be involving in the duties of the Department of Agriculture or the Provincial Departments of Agriculture.

5.1.3 For stream of Agriculture Research

(a) An Officer who holds a post of Research Assistant, Soil Surveyor or Land Evaluation Officer in Special Grade of the Sri Lanka Technological Service

Or

(b) An Officer who holds a post of Research Assistant, Soil Surveyor or Land Evaluation Officer and has completed a minimum period of ten (10) years active and satisfactory service in the Sri Lanka Technological Service.

Or

(c) An Officer of the Associate Officer Service category who has obtained a four year Bachelor's degree in Agriculture from a University recognized by the University Grants Commission or four-year degree in Bachelor of Science in the subjects of Botany, Chemistry or Zoology obtained from a University recognized by the University Grant Commission and has completed five (05) years active and satisfactory period of service under the Department of Agriculture or Provincial Departments of Agriculture and has directly involved or be involving in the duties of the Department of Agriculture or the Provincial Departments of Agriculture.

Or

(d) An Officer who holds a post of Research Assistant, Soil Surveyor or Land